

WORKSHOP SCENARIO

“European ABC: Educational Workshops for Seniors”

1. Basic Information

Workshop title: “Introducing a common currency across the entire European Union would bring more benefits than drawbacks.”

Module:

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Duration: 120 minutes

Number of participants: 12–20 participants

2. Workshop Objectives

General objectives:

- To raise participants’ awareness of the introduction of the single currency, the euro, in all Member States.
- To encourage active civic engagement and critical reflection on the possibility of monetary union within the European Union.

Specific objectives:

- Participants understand the concept of adopting the euro as its currency instead of the current zloty?.
- Participants develop argumentation, communication, and critical thinking skills.
- Participants learn the structure and principles of an Oxford-style debate.

3. Target Group Description

- The workshops are designed for seniors aged 60+ interested in current social, economic, and European issues. Participants may have varying levels of knowledge about the European Union and monetary policy, but all bring valuable life experience and perspectives to the discussion.

- The workshops encourage seniors to reflect on how adopting the euro affects everyday life, including prices, savings, pensions, and economic stability. Through structured discussion and participation in an Oxford-style debate, participants have the opportunity to exchange views, strengthen critical thinking skills, and actively engage in civic dialogue.

4. Methods Used

- moderated discussion
- group work
- simulation game
- Oxford-style debate
- brainstorming
- reflective discussion

5. Materials and Teaching Aids

- flipchart and markers
- printed debate rules
- role cards (Proposition / Opposition / Audience)
- paper and pens
- timer or stopwatch
- optional projector for displaying the debate motion

6. Workshop Flow

6.1. Introduction

The facilitator welcomes participants and introduces the topic of the workshop: “Introducing a common currency across the entire European Union would bring more benefits than drawbacks.”

The facilitator explains that the session will be conducted in the form of an Oxford-style debate, a structured and respectful way of discussing controversial issues and presenting different points of view.

The following debate motion is presented to the group: “Should Poland adopt the euro as its currency instead of the current zloty?”

The facilitator introduces the basic rules of an Oxford debate:

- there are two sides: **the Proposition** (supporting the motion) and **the Opposition** (disagreeing with the motion),
- each side presents arguments in a structured order,
- speakers must respect the time limits,
- participants should respond to arguments rather than criticize individuals,
- the audience listens actively, asks questions, and votes at the end.

The roles are also explained:

- Moderator – leads the debate and ensures the rules are respected,
- Time manager – controls the time given for each speaker
- Speakers – present arguments for or against the motion,
- Audience/Jury – listens, asks questions, and evaluates the debate.

To activate the group, the facilitator may ask:

- Have you ever participated in a formal debate before?
- What do you think makes a good discussion?

A few short responses from participants help create an open and engaging atmosphere.

Timing: 35 - 45 minutes

6.2. Main Part — Educational Activities

Activity 1:

Objective: To prepare participants for active and informed participation in the Oxford-style debate.

Description: Participants are divided into groups and work together to prepare arguments either in favour of or against the debate motion.

Instructions:

- The moderator divides the participants into three groups: supporters, opponents and the audience/jury.
- Each side is tasked with preparing at least three key arguments to support their position.
- Participants are encouraged to draw on personal experiences, practical examples from everyday life, and social and civic perspectives.
- The audience group prepares 2–3 questions to ask both sides during the debate.

- To support the preparation process, the moderator may write key questions on the board, such as: Should Poland adopt the euro? What challenges do Polish citizens face in connection with the plan to introduce the euro in Poland? What should public institutions do to ensure a democratic process for introducing the single European currency in our country?
- The moderator moves between the groups, facilitates the discussion and ensures that all participants are engaged.

Materials: Role cards, paper, pens, flipchart

Activity 2:

Objective: To develop communication, critical thinking, and argumentation skills through structured discussion.

Description: Participants take part in a moderated Oxford-style debate based on the prepared motion.

Instructions:

- The facilitator acts as the moderator and conducts the debate according to the following structure:
- Opening by the moderator
- First speaker of the Proposition – 3 minutes
- First speaker of the Opposition – 3 minutes
- Second speaker of the Proposition – 3 minutes
- Second speaker of the Opposition – 3 minutes
- Third speaker of the Proposition – 3 minutes
- Third speaker of the Opposition – 3 minutes
- Fourth speaker of the Proposition – 3 minutes
- Fourth speaker of the Opposition – 3 minutes
- Questions from the audience – 15 minutes
- Final statements from both sides – 2 minutes each
- Audience vote and short reflection
- The moderator ensures that all participants are treated respectfully, everyone has equal opportunity to speak, and the discussion remains focused on the topic.
- At the end of the debate, the audience votes on which side presented the more convincing arguments.

Timing: 43-45 minutes

Materials: Timer, printed debate rules

6.3. Summary and Reflection

- The moderator encourages participants to reflect on the course of the debate and the topic itself.
- Suggested questions for reflection: Did any of the arguments change your view on the matter? What was the strongest argument put forward during the debate? What should public institutions in Europe do to introduce a single currency across all European Union countries in a democratic manner? How can this be achieved without overstepping economic, emotional and cultural boundaries?
- The moderator summarises the key takeaways from the session: the introduction of a single currency can create both opportunities and barriers. It brings both hope and uncertainty.
- The session concludes with a brief summary and thanks to the participants for their active involvement.

7. Workshop Evaluation

- a short verbal feedback round at the end of the session,
- or a simple written evaluation form.

Suggested evaluation questions:

- What did you learn during the workshop?
- What part of the workshop was most interesting for you?
- Did you feel comfortable participating in the debate?
- What could be improved in future workshops?

Timing: 25-35 minutes

8. Recommendations

- Use clear and accessible language throughout the session.
- Adjust the pace of the workshop to the participants' needs and comfort level.
- Encourage all participants to contribute, including those who are less confident speaking in public.
- Create a respectful and supportive atmosphere where different opinions are welcome.
- If needed, the facilitator may provide examples or prompts to help participants formulate arguments.

9. Attachments

- Oxford debate rules handout
- Role cards (Proposition / Opposition / Audience)
- Debate motion card
- Evaluation form